

ECOLOGIST



SALARY

Newly qualified ecologist ★★★★★

Experienced ecologist ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Many potential employers, especially in government, environmental agencies, and academia • Fierce competition for higher-level posts

JOB DESCRIPTION

An ecologist studies the relationship between plants and animals, and their interaction with their physical environment. They may specialize in a particular habitat (such as a rain forest) or groups of species (such as lions). Their work could range from conducting research on global issues to developing plans for local land management. A deep passion to protect the environment and biodiversity drives most ecologists.



CAREER PATHS

To work as an ecologist, you need a degree or graduate qualification in ecology or biological science. Opportunities exist with national and local government agencies, environmental consultancies, and Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs) that campaign for the environment and wildlife.

VOLUNTEER Volunteering for a conservation NGO and gaining experience in the field will improve your chances of employment once you obtain a relevant degree.

GRADUATE You should hold a relevant degree, and be experienced in carrying out field research and data analysis. Graduate degrees are becoming increasingly sought after.



MARINE ECOLOGIST

Studies marine organisms and ecosystems to protect biodiversity, conserve habitats, and help preserve commercially important fish stocks and other marine life.



ECOLOGIST Early in your career, you will carry out field surveys, write reports, and provide advice to various organizations. With experience, you could move into management roles or work on environmental policy in a government department or with an NGO, before specializing in a number of different fields.